

1922, September 27.

faction in Ireland - or of any party in Ireland -- for example just now, the legitimately established Republic and the said free-state, which later as its authors evidently hoped, was to sneak real British - fashioned into the place of the former, he would simply point to the history of British interest in Ireland and ask the one little question: "On which side of the dispute is British Favor?" In the present crisis, the thickest thug in the tombs prison to whatever side he might incline, would wonder that anyone might be so "thick" as honestly to ask such a question -- perhaps rather, so ill-informed.

The wail, therefore, that went up all over British quarters at the fall of unfortunate Collins, not in December, when by the weight of his own name on the London Pact, he lost his balance and tumbled from the heights of Patriotic confidence to the plain of England's "Hero Irishman", but eight months later, when pushing the interests of that pact - some of course say of Britain too - he fell from said plain, beyond all hope of British dictation, - that British Wail, I say -- would indicate satisfactorily to my way of reasoning, just about in how much the death of Collins, R.I.P., might, under existing circumstances, be rightly termed "A SAD BLOW FOR IRELAND".

Pardon me the rather long digression; but you will probably see thereby that there must be quite a little obtainable information about present Irish-British relationship other than, perhaps the majority of our, otherwise honest Editors seem to be concerned about. It is hoped, too, that the British views of the Irish situation - perhaps we ought to say the Northcliff-Hearst and Co. music, so in harmony with the little Welsh "Wizard's" notes, and so cleverly and unsuspectingly danced to by so many Editors and even Clergy and other leaders in America, - are dangerously at variance with both fact and reason; And therefore, dangerously far from Pius X's ideal of an "efficient Catholic Press."

Now, as to your above mentioned "SANE VIEW OF IRELAND"; briefly, you start out quite as a thinker, on the authority of fair observation and honest conviction might be expected to do; and you rightly admonish "ordinary Readers" to beware of accepting "Newspaper Reports" above referred to as "Gospel Truths" But you do not tell us why such newspapers should be suspected; or why they dare not tell the truth - especially about Ireland - even if those immediately responsible were so disposed. Let me ask you: Is it not because the Power behind such newspapers is quite the same as that which through calumny and hypocrisy got our own Country to take such a regrettable share in what has resulted in the present degradation of Central Europe? Is it not because of their direct or indirect dependence for existence on that same power - that furthermore and immediately after the "truce" uniformed its most inhuman criminals (Higher intellectuals excepted,) and sent them from British penitentiaries equipped with every implement of modern savagery against poor little Ireland? Aye, Ireland unarmed except by her Faith in God! Unoffensive except for her surpassing determination to stand by the principles of righteous Freedom -- principles for which from 1914 to 1919 humanity was bled white! Great God! Is it to be all for nothing?